

OK, so that's 10 questions already—and a walkthrough of those ten should clear things up a bit.

6.3.1 Connection Speed

Remember that Webmail (such as Gmail and Yahoo! Mail) has several features that take time to download, ads that take up bandwidth, and more. So if you're on broadband, you're fine, but with dialup, the Webmail experience can sometimes be frustrating. Also remember that POP3 can often be a bad thing if you have a slow connection; if someone sends you a mail with a 7 MB attachment, you'll have no way of knowing—you might sit a long while downloading the mail only to discover it's a silly forward. IMAP could be the best answer for those on dialup—you just download the header information, which happens in a jiffy, and download only the mails you want to.

6.3.2 The Money

If you pay for data transferred, POP3 (and, to a lesser extent, Webmail) could be bad news; IMAP should be preferred for the reasons mentioned in §8.3.1. If you have a broadband connection and pay by the hour, even a 7 MB mail won't take long to download—so POP3 is not so much of an offender. Webmail could be a bad choice if you pay by the hour; each transaction (delete mail, read mail, move mail) takes time.

6.3.3 Offline Activity

It should be obvious: if you're using Webmail, you need to be connected to read your mail. On the other hand, if you're using a mail program, you can read yesterday's mail anytime today (using POP3, and with IMAP for the messages you downloaded).

6.3.4 Mobility

Again, it should also be clear that IMAP is to be preferred if you connect from several locations. You treat your mailbox not as a local repository but as a remote one, like we said. Also, Webmail is good if you access your mail from several locations, but you need to remember that load times are slower, so it also depends on the connection speeds at the locations you connect from.